



"Bird-shaped" grip

Cross-shaped guard

Downward curving blade

◀ XIPHOS

Date Early 6th century BCE

Origin Greece

Material Iron

The *xiphos* was the sword most commonly carried by hoplites in the 6th century BCE. Its thick hilt had a cross-shaped guard and the blade swelled to a wide point near the tip, making it a very strong weapon. Used for thrusting in close combat, it was carried in a sheath worn under the left arm. The version pictured here is a modern replica.

► ASPIS

Date c. 500 BCE

Origin Greece

Material Wood, bronze

This modern replica of an *aspis* (or *hoplon*) shield is made from wood, although they were also often covered with bronze, with further bronze reinforcement around the rim. Up to 1m (3ft) in diameter, they gently curved inwards to provide some protection to the soldier's sides, and had an *antilabe* (handle) and a bronze *porpax* (loop) on the back. This allowed the soldier to carry a weapon and a shield in the same hand.



Wide leaf-shaped blade

Broken tip

▲ GREEK SPEARHEAD

Date 6th–5th centuries BCE

Origin Greece

Weight 370g (13oz)

Length 31cm (12¼in)

The spear was the hoplite's main weapon; the *kopis* (short sword) was used only if the spear broke during fighting. Originally hoplites carried two spears that could be thrown, but these were later replaced by one long, thrusting spear.



Indentation for bronze securing ring

Socket for spear shaft

▲ HOPLITE SPEAR BUTT

Date 4th century BCE

Origin Macedonia

Length 38cm (15in)

As hoplite spears grew longer, particularly from the 4th century BCE in the phalanxes of Philip of Macedon and Alexander the Great, they needed a counterweight to balance the spear-point at the other end. The spear butt provided this support and could also be used as a weapon if the spearhead broke.

Bronze rim of shield



Scorpion was Spartan symbol of the city of Geronthrae